

Artie Ficial

Executive Director of the Meridian Museum



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Diplomatic under pressure; image-conscious; dryly funny; allergic to public chaos. Play him as someone who is always hosting, even when he is not technically the host.

Artie treats the gala like a state visit and the coat check like a diplomatic incident. Polished, ambitious, and almost unnervingly composed, Artie has spent the last six years turning the Meridian from a respected regional institution into a museum that expects to be mentioned in the same sentence as the Met. He can greet a donor, calm a curator, and redirect a disaster without changing facial expression. Tonight is his biggest gala yet, and he intends for it to look effortless.

- Works closely with Claire O'Scuro, though the two disagree about how much spectacle a museum should tolerate.
- Relies on Monet Bags for the numbers and Sue Venir for donor agreements.
- Anya Tique hired Artie years ago and still occasionally speaks to him as if he were an intern.

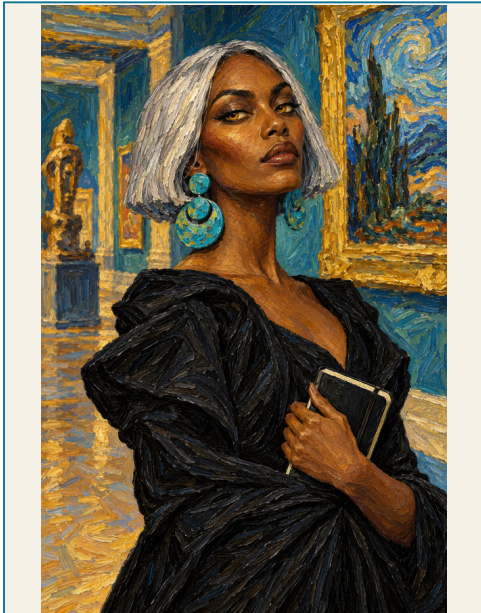
COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Black tie or an immaculate dark suit; a very official-looking gala program. Optional pocket square, tasteful lapel pin, slim folder or program.

October 30, 2026 / Meridian Museum Gala

Claire O'Scuro

Chief Curator of World Cultures



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Controlled, observant, skeptical, quietly competitive. You do not need to be loud; a raised eyebrow can do half the work.

Claire can identify a fifteenth-century glaze at twenty paces and a crooked label from the parking lot. Claire is the intellectual engine behind Treasures of the World: brilliant, exacting, and visibly pained by sloppy labels, bad lighting, and people who call every old object an 'artifact.' She has spent years building the Meridian's scholarly reputation and knows the exhibition better than anyone alive. She is gracious when she chooses to be and devastating when she edits.

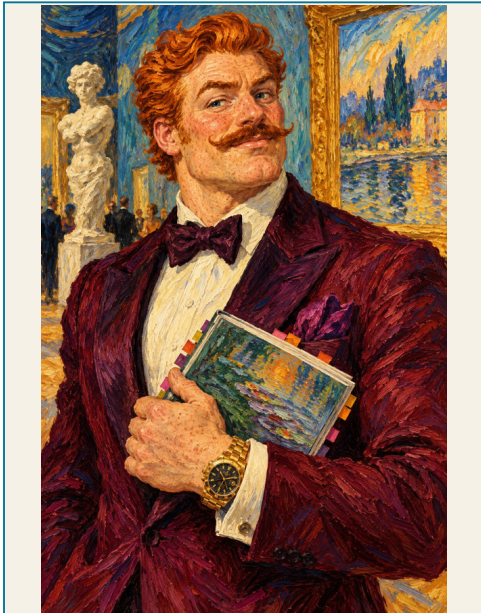
- Professional counterpart to Artie Ficial; they respect each other and routinely disagree.
- Mentors Reed DeLabel, the museum's graduate fellow.
- Frequently consults Chip Patina and Dr. Art E. Fact on difficult objects.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Elegant gallery-black with one distinctive art-history touch: sculptural jewelry, silk scarf, statement earrings, or beautifully severe glasses. You might carry a pencil and small notebook.

Hugh Bidder

International Art Dealer & Collector Liaison



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Smooth, sociable, opportunistic, impossible to embarrass. Treat every conversation like a deal that has not yet revealed itself.

Hugh insists everything is priceless, right up until he names a price. Hugh is the person wealthy collectors call when they want something no one else seems able to find. Charming, fast-talking, and always perfectly dressed, he insists that art dealing is mostly about trust, discretion, and knowing which flight lands in Geneva before breakfast. He has brokered several loans in tonight's exhibition and knows half the room professionally.

- Has represented Elon Mosaic in private acquisitions, though neither likes admitting how often they need the other.
- Competes with Saul D. Bid for major consignments.
- Ella Gance considers him useful but never entirely trustworthy.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Fashion-forward dinner jacket or sharp suit, polished shoes, expensive-looking watch (real or fake), pocket square. Optional slim catalogue with sticky tabs.

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Monet Bags

Chief Financial Officer of the Meridian Museum



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Quick, pragmatic, wry, unimpressed by grandeur for grandeur's sake. You notice costs other people pretend not to see.

Monet can locate a missing cent faster than anyone can locate the missing antiquity. Monet can tell you exactly how much tonight's floral installation cost, which donor paid for it, and which line item everyone is pretending it came from. She is sharp, stylish, practical, and chronically surrounded by people with expensive visions and no budgets. If the museum survives its ambitions, Monet will probably be the reason.

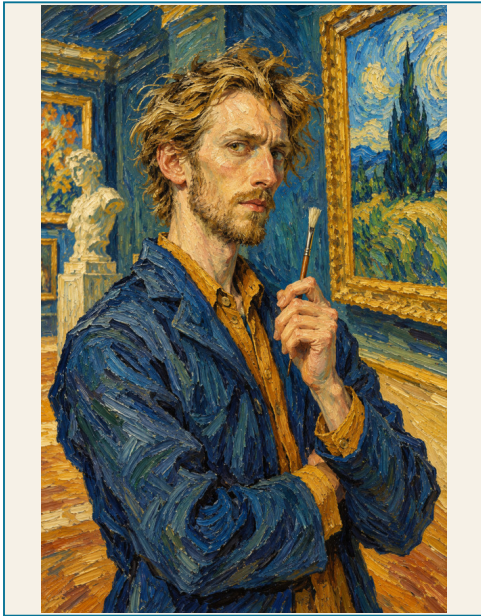
- Works constantly with Artie Ficial and Sue Venir.
- Has a friendly rivalry with Minnie Malist, whose gala ideas tend to arrive before their price tags.
- Anya Tique likes Monet because she asks questions trustees hate answering.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Modern cocktail attire or tailored suit; sleek, practical, expensive-looking without being flashy. You might carry a small ledger, calculator, or pen clipped to a folder.

Chip Patina

Chief Conservator



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Dry, meticulous, tactile, slightly territorial. You care more about what is physically true than what is socially convenient.

Chip considers a fingerprint on a display case a personal attack. Chip is responsible for keeping centuries-old objects from losing arguments with humidity, fingerprints, gravity, and other people. Patient with objects and less patient with humans, he has the calm authority of someone who has seen a priceless painting survive a flood and a donor nearly destroy one with hand lotion. He knows what was repaired, altered, cleaned, and quietly worried over before tonight.

- Works closely with Claire O'Scuro and Cary Crates.
- Often spars intellectually with Art E. Fact over what conservation can and cannot prove.
- Anya Tique trusts Chip's judgment more than most committees.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Dark suit or smart workwear made gala-appropriate; rolled sleeves under jacket, conservator gloves tucked into a pocket, loupe or small brush as a prop.

Dada DiCapo

Performance Artist & Cultural Celebrity



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Confident, theatrical, mischievous, intelligent. Commit to bits, but never let the joke make you foolish.

Dada describes standing still as an endurance piece and invoices accordingly. Dada makes expensive people uncomfortable in aesthetically impeccable ways. Her performances have involved mirrored rooms, silent choirs, a twelve-hour dinner party, and once an empty pedestal that sold for more than most houses. She is magnetic, playful, and perfectly capable of making a sincere point while everyone wonders whether they are already inside the piece.

- Former art-school collaborator of Vincent Van Faux; they remain close enough to annoy one another professionally.
- Elle Loominate has assisted on several of Dada's installations.
- Drew Conclusions has alternated between praising and savaging Dada in print.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: High-fashion black tie with one strange choice: opera gloves, sculptural headpiece, monochrome outfit, dramatic makeup, oversized flower, etc. The goal is 'gallery opening where photographers are present.'

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Vincent Van Faux

Celebrated Contemporary Painter



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ACTING TIPS

Warm, competitive, mercurial, self-aware enough to joke about his ego but not enough to lose it.

Vincent believes even his shopping lists belong in a retrospective. Vincent became famous young and has been trying ever since to convince people that this is not the same thing as becoming famous accidentally. His paintings are lush, moody, and highly collectible; his interviews are less reliable. He is charming, vain in a way he almost gets away with, and genuinely serious about his work when nobody is watching.

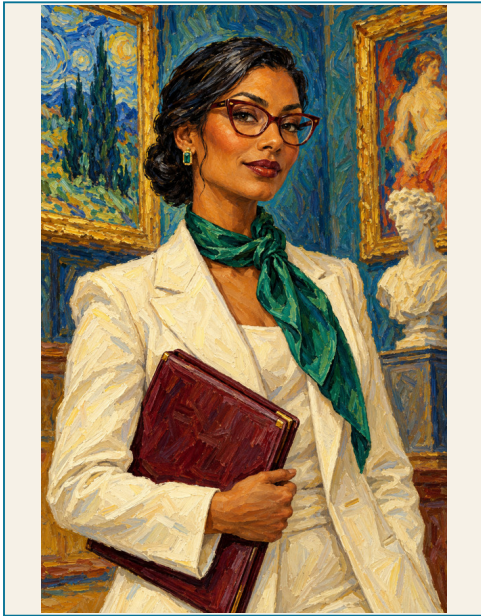
- Long creative history with Dada DiCapo.
- Al Baster thinks Vincent gets too much press for work that can hang on a wall without engineering permits.
- Ella Gance owns one of Vincent's early paintings and mentions this strategically.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Black tie with artist flair: velvet jacket, open collar, paint-spattered vintage shoes, dramatic ring, scarf, or deliberately imperfect formalwear.

Sue Venir

Cultural Property Attorney



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Precise, formidable, patient, amused by sloppy certainty. Ask pointed questions and answer only the question actually asked.

Sue corrects the fine print on dinner menus. Sue is the lawyer museums call when an object has three owners, four countries, six contradictory export documents, and one increasingly angry newspaper. She is elegant, surgical, and frighteningly good at making a sentence mean exactly what she intends. Tonight she is attending as counsel to several parties who would prefer not to be described as 'parties.'

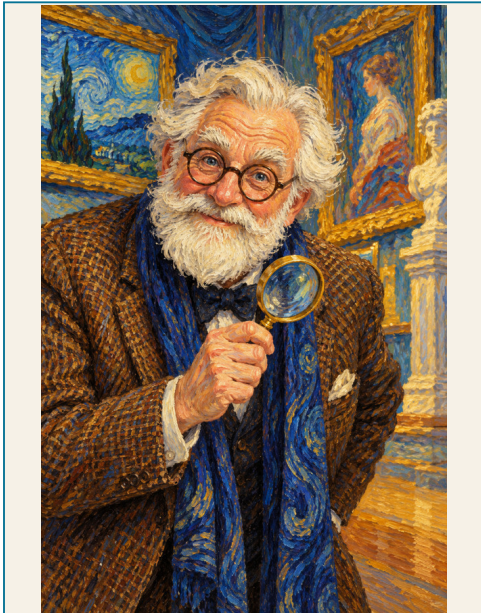
- Works regularly with Artie Ficial and Monet Bags.
- Friendly professional adversary of Mona Lott; they have argued opposite sides of restitution cases and still have dinner afterward.
- Art E. Fact has supplied expert opinions for her cases.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Structured formalwear, crisp lines, minimal jewelry, immaculate folder or document case. Optional reading glasses for dramatic removal.

Dr. Art E. Fact

Professor of Art History & Provenance Scholar



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Intense, professorial, curious, occasionally pedantic, sincerely excited by evidence.

Art has never met a footnote he could not lengthen. Art has built a career tracing the lives of objects through wars, estates, auctions, private collections, and suspicious gaps in paperwork. Brilliant, argumentative, and allergic to oversimplification, he can turn one stamp on the back of a frame into a forty-minute lecture and somehow make it compelling. Treasures of the World contains several objects he has researched personally.

- Supervises Reed DeLabel's doctoral research.
- Debates restitution policy regularly with Mona Lott and Robin Banks.
- Chip Patina is one of the few people Art trusts to tell him when physical evidence contradicts his theory.

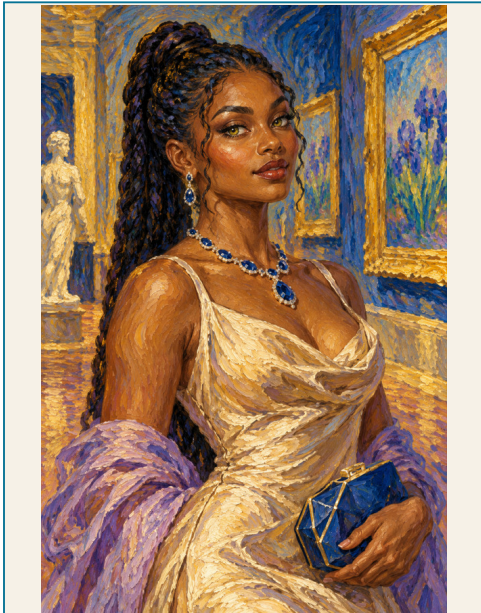
COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Professor at a donor gala: dark suit, tweed or textured jacket, distinctive glasses, scholarly scarf, pocket notebook. Optional magnifier or archival pencil.

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Tess Tament

Philanthropist & Heir to the Larceny Family Fortune



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Composed, witty, guarded, generous when she chooses. You grew up around power and recognize its rituals instantly.

Tess speaks fluent inheritance and has strong opinions about the seating plan. Tess is the only member of the Larceny dynasty who can attend an arts gala without immediately being asked for a check, mostly because everyone waits several minutes first. She is stylish, socially fluent, and harder to read than her public image suggests. She funds young artists, hates being introduced as an heiress, and has learned to smile through questions about her family.

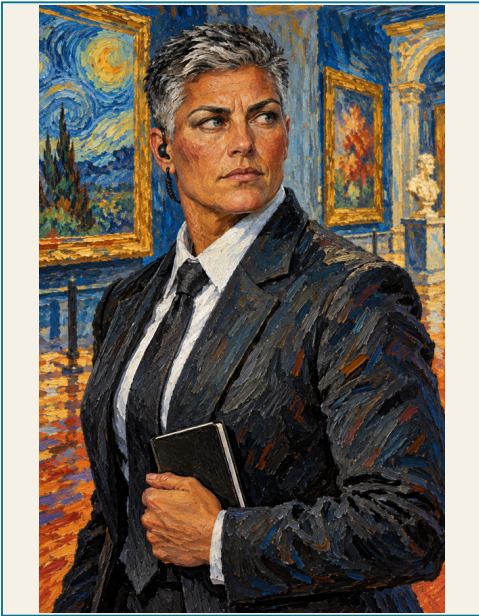
- Moves in the same collector circle as Elon Mosaic and Ella Gance.
- Has commissioned work from Dada DiCapo.
- Anya Tique has known Tess since childhood and refuses to be impressed by her surname.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Modern gala glamour: elegant cocktail dress or formal suit, statement jewelry, designer-looking clutch, effortless rather than ostentatious.

Barb Dwyer

Director of Museum Security & Former Art-Crimes Investigator



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Low-key, skeptical, dry, watchful. Ask where people were and remember their answers.

Barb has already assessed which guests could fit through the air vents. Barb spent years investigating stolen art before discovering that museums contain nearly as much intrigue with better climate control. He is calm, observant, and difficult to surprise. He notices open doors, blocked sight lines, unattended bags, and people who suddenly become interested in exits. Tonight he would prefer everyone simply enjoy the exhibition, which means they almost certainly will not.

- Coordinates closely with Artie Ficial and Chip Patina.
- Frequently clashes with Paige Turner over access and with Robin Banks over protest tactics.
- Minnie Malist keeps changing layouts after Barb has already approved them.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Dark suit, discreet earpiece prop if desired, security-style watch, small notebook. A senior museum security look could work well.

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Paige Turner

Investigative Arts Journalist



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Curious, direct, quick, socially fearless. Ask questions people wish you would save for email.

Paige asks innocent questions with a recorder visibly running. Paige covers the art world the way other reporters cover city hall: money, power, access, and who benefits when everyone agrees not to ask a question. Her pieces are sharp, deeply sourced, and occasionally followed by nervous legal letters. She has been invited tonight because excluding her would look worse.

- Professional rival of Drew Conclusions, whose criticism Paige considers entertaining but insufficiently documented.
- Faye Stop has photographed several of Paige's stories.
- Sue Venir has threatened to quote Paige's own articles back to her in court.

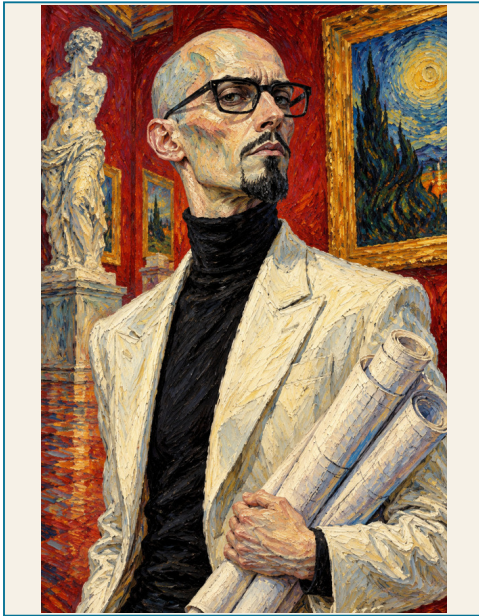
COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Cocktail attire with practical reporter touches: blazer, notebook, pen, compact camera if desired. Stylish enough for the gala, ready enough for a press scrum.

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Frank Lloyd Wrong

Exhibition Architect & Designer



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ACTING TIPS

Aesthetic, controlled, mildly pretentious in a lovable way, easily offended by bad placement rather than bad manners.

Frank considers doors a regrettable compromise in an otherwise excellent wall. Frank designed the physical experience of Treasures of the World: every wall angle, sight line, spotlight, pedestal, and dramatic reveal. He is tasteful, exacting, and deeply convinced that visitors would behave better if they understood circulation. He has strong opinions about fonts, cords, and anything that interrupts a clean visual field.

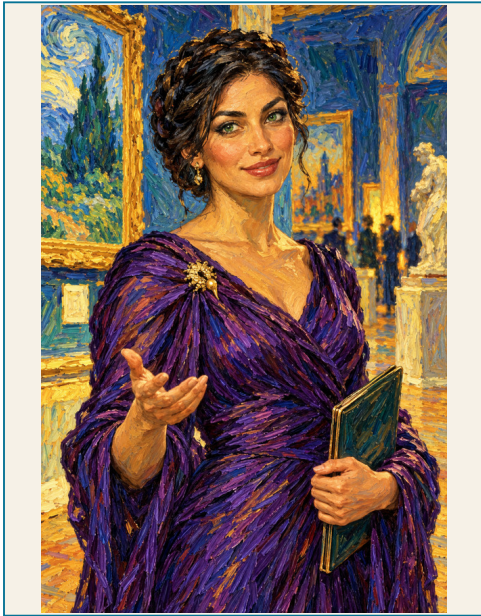
- Creative rival of sculptor Al Baster after a very public argument about scale.
- Works constantly with Minnie Malist, who keeps trying to add flowers where Frank designed negative space.
- Chip Patina has veto power over several of Frank's more adventurous display ideas.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Architectural formalwear: monochrome suit, turtleneck with jacket, sharply cut black attire, interesting glasses, rolled plans or a small laser measure prop.

Mona Lott

International Cultural Heritage Envoy



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Elegant, diplomatic, strategic, warm until precision is required. You can disagree without ever sounding flustered.

Mona can turn a disagreement about a bowl into an international summit. Mona moves between embassies, museums, ministries, and negotiation tables where everyone insists the issue is 'purely cultural' while bringing three lawyers. She is poised, persuasive, and very difficult to rush. Her work focuses on contested cultural property and long-term international loans.

- Long-running professional friendship and rivalry with Sue Venir.
- Frequently debates Art E. Fact and Robin Banks on how restitution should actually work.
- Artie Ficial has courted her support for several international partnerships.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Refined diplomatic formalwear; jewel tones, elegant suit or dress, subtle cultural or heritage-inspired accessory worn respectfully. Optional slim portfolio.

Elon Mosaic

Tech Founder, Collector & Museum Patron



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, socially confident, competitive, eager to demonstrate taste without looking eager.

Elon keeps suggesting that the museum should pivot to subscription antiquities. Elon made a fortune building software and has spent the last five years trying to become the sort of collector whose taste is discussed rather than merely his net worth. He is enthusiastic, competitive, and genuinely knowledgeable enough to resent anyone who assumes otherwise. His collection mixes contemporary art, design, and objects he describes as 'historically underpriced.'

- Buys through Hugh Bidder more often than either admits.
- Runs in the same social orbit as Tess Tament and Ella Gance.
- Drew Conclusions once described his collection as 'an algorithm discovering patina,' which Elon has not forgotten.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Modern black tie with tech-founder looseness: excellent jacket, minimal sneakers or polished shoes, unusual watch, bold glasses. Optional auction paddle as a joke prop.

Anya Tique

Founding Curator Emerita



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Imperious, funny, observant, utterly unimpressed by status. Age gives you permission to say what everyone else edits.

Anya remembers when the museum was two rooms and an argument. Anya helped build the Meridian's collection when the museum had more ambition than money and fewer committees than fire extinguishers. She is sharp, unsentimental, impossible to flatter, and delighted that everyone now treats decisions she made on folding tables as institutional history.

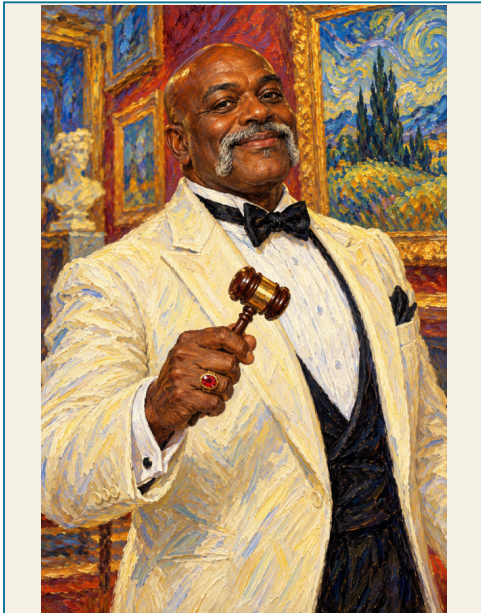
- Hired Artie Ficial early in his career.
- Trusts Chip Patina and Anne E. Dote.
- Has known Tess Tament since Tess was a child.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Old-school gala elegance: brooch, gloves, shawl, pearls, cane if desired, formal suit or dress with unmistakable presence.

Saul D. Bid

Chairman of Gavel & Rowe Auction House



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Old-school charm, status-aware, patient, competitive. Speak as if the room has already agreed you belong in it.

Saul cannot ask someone to pass the salt without opening bidding. Saul has sold paintings, antiquities, estates, scandals, and at least one chair that required its own insurance rider. Urbane and ceremonious, he treats every conversation like a private viewing and every silence like a bidding strategy.

- Longtime professional rival of Hugh Bidder.
- Knows Ella Gance and Elon Mosaic from the auction circuit.
- Anya Tique remembers when Saul was still carrying catalogues for someone else.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Classic tuxedo or formal dark suit, silk pocket square, signet ring, reading glasses, optional miniature auction gavel.

Elle Loominate

Textile Artist & Designer



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Creative, grounded, quietly funny, detail-oriented. You notice what people wear and how things are made.

Elle has identified every fabric in the room, including the suspiciously shiny tuxedo. Elle turns weaving, embroidery, salvage fabric, and obsessive handwork into installations that critics call intimate and collectors call surprisingly difficult to ship. She is warm, observant, and capable of discussing thread count with the intensity of a military briefing.

- Has assisted Dada DiCapo on several installations.
- Friendly with Vincent Van Faux from the local art circuit.
- Chip Patina has advised her on displaying fragile textiles.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Formal outfit with texture: embroidered jacket, woven scarf, textile jewelry, patterned dress, unusual fabric. Handmade touches encouraged.

Reed DeLabel

Doctoral Fellow in Art History



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Eager, cerebral, anxious in a useful way, unexpectedly bold when the evidence is on your side.

Reed reads every label aloud, including the exit sign. Reed is the youngest scholar attached to the exhibition and has been trying very hard to behave like this is normal. He is brilliant, earnest, slightly overprepared, and burdened with the knowledge that every person here could someday write a recommendation letter or ruin his evening.

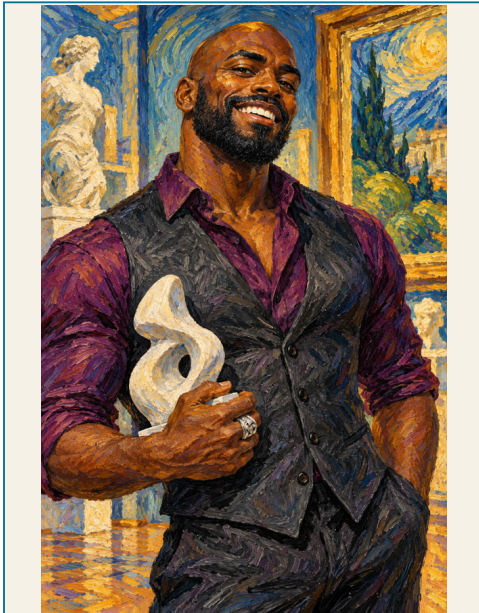
- Doctoral student of Art E. Fact.
- Mentored informally by Claire O'Scuro.
- Anne E. Dote keeps rescuing Reed from conversations with donors who ask whether art history is a real degree.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Best-suit energy: formal but slightly less effortless than the veterans. Optional extras: glasses, a notebook or a museum catalogue full of tabs.

Al Baster

Sculptor & Public-Art Star



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Big presence, playful arrogance, generous when admired, combative when minimized.

Al considers a pedestal a sculpture that has given up on itself. Al makes monumental sculpture in stone, steel, and whatever else can require a crane. He is charismatic, physically expressive, and convinced that architecture should know when to get out of sculpture's way. His newest commission occupies the museum entrance and at least three opinions per square foot.

- Creative rival of Frank Lloyd Wright after an argument about the entrance installation.
- Friendly competitor of Vincent Van Faux.
- Minnie Malist once designed a gala around one of Al's sculptures and still talks about the insurance.

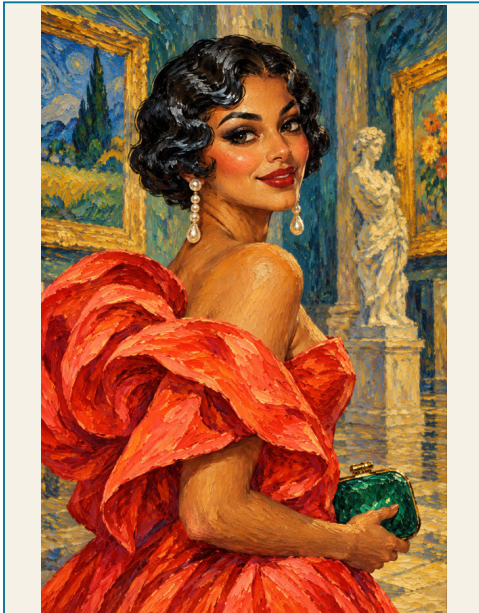
COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Bold formalwear, chunky ring, sculptural accessories, dark shirt with jacket, perhaps a dust-marked work boot paired with gala clothes.

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Ella Gance

Collector, Style Patron & Society Fixture



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Charming, strategic, stylish, lightly competitive. Compliments can be sincere and still accomplish something.

Ella dresses as though the society pages arrive before the guests. Ella has excellent taste, excellent photographers, and excellent instincts about which artists will become impossible to buy next year. She hosts salons, funds commissions, and somehow makes every acquisition look accidental. Beneath the polish, she is a serious collector who remembers exactly who dismissed what five years ago.

- Collects work by Vincent Van Faux and Elle Loominate.
- Competes socially and at auction with Elon Mosaic.
- Uses Hugh Bidder when discretion matters and Saul D. Bid when spectacle does.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Fashion-forward gala look, statement jewelry, dramatic clutch, bold color or silhouette. For inspiration, think of 'photographed on arrival.'

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Drew Conclusions

Art Critic & Cultural Podcaster



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Dry, perceptive, skeptical, socially nimble. Deliver observations as if they occurred to you three minutes before everyone else.

Drew calls everything derivative, especially things he likes. Drew can make a museum director nervous with a headline and an artist furious with a compliment. Their reviews are incisive, funny, and widely read; their podcast is where the art world goes to hear itself discussed by someone who may not be impressed.

- Friendly rival of Paige Turner.
- Has reviewed Vincent Van Faux, Dada DiCapo, Al Baster, and Elle Loominate.
- Elon Mosaic remembers an especially brutal line about his collection.

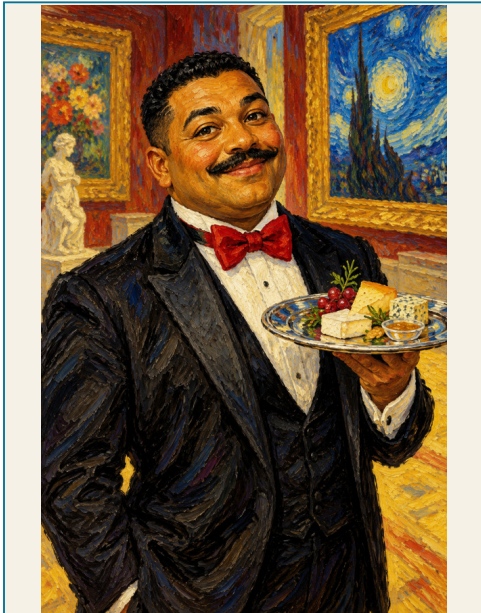
COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Smart, artsy formalwear: black with one eccentric element, distinctive glasses, scarf, vintage jacket, notebook. Gender presentation entirely flexible.

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Brie DeVivre

Head Caterer & Hospitality Director



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Competent, sociable, quietly authoritative, hard to rattle. You see the room from the service side.

Brie has planned a cheese course more carefully than most people plan a wedding. Brie runs high-end events with the serene expression of a person mentally tracking forty-seven moving parts. He knows who asked for the vegan plate, who changed the seating chart, who is pretending not to be hungry, and exactly how long a tray can sit before someone complains.

- Works closely with Minnie Malist and Monet Bags.
- Barb Dwyer has made Brie revise service routes repeatedly for security reasons.
- Artie Ficial trusts Brie to keep donors fed while everyone else panics.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Sharp black suit or upscale catering uniform, tie or bow tie, folded service towel, small order pad. A luxury event professional could be your inspiration.

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Cary Crates

Senior Art Handler & Installation Specialist



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Grounded, competent, laconic, surprisingly funny when you choose to speak.

Cary knows which crate holds a masterpiece and which one holds the extension cords. Cary is the person trusted to move objects worth more than the building without dropping either. He knows crates, rigging, mounts, gloves, freight elevators, and exactly which curators become unbearable during installation week. Practical and calm, he is one of the few people in the room who has physically touched most of the exhibition.

- Works daily with Chip Patina.
- Has developed mutual respect with Frank Lloyd Wrong despite arguing about impossible installation drawings.
- Al Baster likes Cary because Cary actually knows how heavy sculpture is.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Clean dark workwear dressed up for a gala: black trousers, sturdy shoes, smart shirt/jacket, work gloves tucked in pocket, measuring tape prop.

Anne E. Dote

Director of Education & Docent Programs



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

Anne can make a school group care about a pot shard. Tonight's donors are proving harder. Anne is responsible for making the museum intelligible to people who did not spend twelve years specializing in one dynasty. Warm, quick, and occasionally subversive, she can turn an academic argument into a great tour question and a donor speech into something children will actually remember.

- Close to Anya Tique, who champions the education program.
- Often rescues Reed DeLabel from awkward public-facing moments.
- Works with Claire O'Scuro to translate scholarship into gallery interpretation.

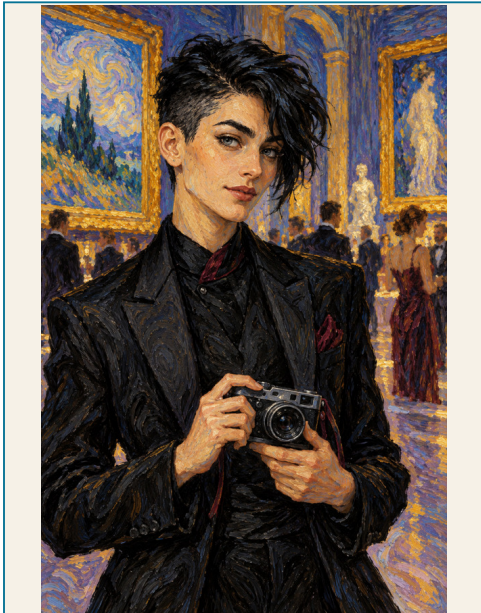
COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Colorful cocktail attire or polished museum-professional look, comfortable shoes, fun brooch or earrings, optional stack of tour cards.

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Faye Stop

Gala Photographer & Editorial Portraitist



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Observant, understated, curious, visually minded. You notice who is standing with whom and what happens at the edge of a room.

Faye will ask you to move half an inch until the end of time. Faye photographs artists, collectors, and public figures for magazines that describe parties like tonight as 'intimate' despite inviting two hundred people. They are quiet when working, socially fluent when not, and very good at being present without becoming the center of the frame.

- Has photographed several investigations for Paige Turner.
- Dada DiCapo loves Faye's work because Faye does not overdirect.
- Ella Gance always knows which side Faye is shooting from.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Elegant all-black or dark cocktail wear, camera as the key prop if available, comfortable shoes, press-style shoulder bag.

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Robin Banks

Cultural Restitution Activist & Nonprofit Organizer



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Focused, bold, principled, socially savvy. Challenge people without turning every conversation into a speech.

Robin has brought a petition, spare pens and absolutely no interest in donor etiquette. Robin campaigns for museums and collectors to return contested cultural objects, publish complete provenance, and stop treating possession as the end of the conversation. She is articulate, strategic, and much more interested in leverage than theatrics—although she knows theatrics can create leverage.

- Frequently debates Art E. Fact and Mona Lott on strategy.
- Barb Dwyer has removed Robin from a museum event before; both remember it.
- Anne E. Dote quietly agrees with more of Robin's critique than museum leadership suspects.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Smart gala attire with activist edge: bold pin, statement scarf, printed tote, elegant suit or dress. A bold accessory may be all you need.

Penny Pincher

Eccentric Private Collector



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Eccentric, charming, nosy, unexpectedly shrewd. Ask questions that sound casual and are not.

Penny is convinced that every museum object would look better in her hallway. Penny collects small paintings, strange decorative objects, and stories about who owned them before she did. She is wealthy enough to ignore trends and old enough to enjoy doing so publicly. Penny has a habit of wandering away from tours and returning with better information than the guide provided.

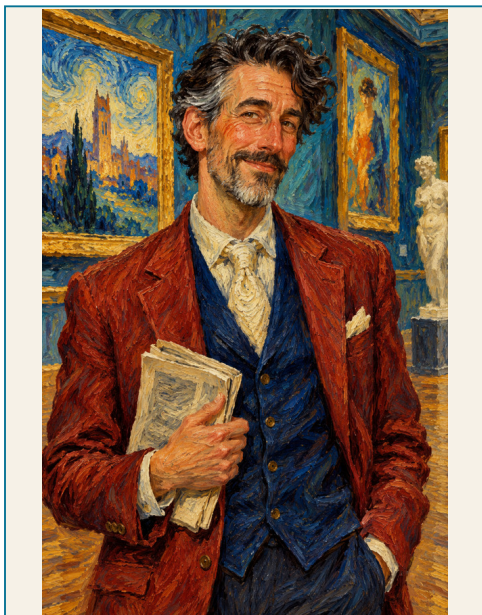
- Old friend of Anya Tique.
- Knows Saul D. Bid from decades of auctions.
- Ella Gance alternates between finding Penny inspiring and alarming.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Eclectic formalwear: vintage jewelry, dramatic brooches, velvet, patterned jacket, gloves, small opera glasses or fan.

Justin Tyme

Tulsa Arts Columnist & Local Historian



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Friendly, curious, locally knowledgeable, a little nosy. You connect people and remember old stories.

Justin remembers the previous scandal and has brought the clipping. Justin knows which gallery used to be a bank, which donor funded which wing, and which local art feud is still alive despite everyone involved pretending otherwise. His column is affectionate, gossipy, and read by exactly the people who claim they never read it.

- Has profiled Artie Ficial and Anya Tique.
- Friendly with Anne E. Dote and Faye Stop.
- Paige Turner considers Justin useful when she needs Tulsa context and dangerous when he starts telling stories.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Cocktail suit or blazer, vintage Tulsa flair if desired, notebook, press card prop, old museum brochure tucked into pocket.

October 30, 2026 / Meridian Museum Gala

Minnie Malist

Gala Event Designer & Creative Producer



The Living Collection / 2026

ACTING TIPS

Energetic, aesthetic, affectionate, slightly chaotic but highly competent. You notice atmosphere first.

Minnie considers restrained lighting a cry for help. Minnie creates the visual spectacle around events like tonight: flowers, lighting, table styling, entrances, reveals, and the precise moment everyone is supposed to gasp. They are exuberant, fast-moving, and convinced that restraint is wonderful when somebody else is responsible for it.

- Works constantly with Frank Lloyd Wrong, who removes half of Minnie's ideas.
- Brie DeVivre is Minnie's favorite partner in event logistics.
- Monet Bags is the person who asks what Minnie's ideas cost.

COSTUME SUGGESTIONS

Optional inspiration: Creative formalwear: floral pin, velvet jacket, unusual bow tie, colorful suit, statement glasses. Optional ribbon swatches or mini lighting plan.